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Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

June 2019

Version: 0.1 Pre-Standardisation



1 9 6 X L T 0 2 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Assessment Writer.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Further copies of this mark scheme are available from oxfordaqaexams.org.uk

Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6-8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills half way through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	- perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task - assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	- thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth - appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	- straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	- straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task - some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	- simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task - generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	- simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task - generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- a simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task - generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	the writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

'Africa remains a mystery even by the end of Marlow's journey.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Africa being a mystery still, perhaps, but Marlow's journey as one of discovery
- bafflement to some extent by what has happened to Kurtz
- limited understanding of African people
- the reader can understand more than Marlow, but the mystery may remain
- strength of emotional response: eg to 'the horror'
- grasp that Marlow shows of colonialism and exploitation
- how Marlow learns to navigate the Congo river.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- journey as structural feature with encounter with Kurtz as narrative climax
- narrative of journey confined to river and immediate surroundings – settings imply limitations of understanding as a consequence
- use of Marlow's reflections on his experience: eg his belief that Kurtz showed profound understanding ('had summed up... had judged. "The horror!"')
- narrative voice – single perspective on journey
- motif of darkness
- setting of Kurtz's station
- dialogue: eg between Marlow and Kurtz.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	2
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F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

To what extent do you agree that money is presented as the main focus of society in *The Great Gatsby*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- wealth of Buchanans – the privileged life they lead
- relative poverty of Wilsons – their desire to escape valley of ashes, money as factor in Myrtle's affair
- Gatsby's pursuit of wealth in hope of attracting Daisy
- wealth and crime: eg Gatsby's bootlegging and Wolfsheim's gangster activities
- parties as examples of conspicuous consumption and decadence
- love for and possession of Daisy being more important for Gatsby
- more restrained attitude of Nick Carraway: eg earning his living honestly, his moral judgements.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative voice and perspective of Nick Carraway
- narrative structure: eg climax of Myrtle's death with subsequent deaths of Gatsby and George Wilson while Daisy escapes justice
- symbols of wealth: eg cars, houses, other property
- use of satire and irony: eg party guests (names, behaviour, dialogue)
- contrast between Gatsby's idealised love and Daisy's materialism
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	3
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Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

'An uncritical portrayal of England and the English.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of *The Remains of the Day*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Stevens' acceptance of the actions and attitudes of an English aristocrat
- how the household might be seen as typically English: eg upstairs-downstairs relationships
- how Stevens' views of life at Darlington Hall are uncritical
- how far formality and reserve in working and personal relationships can be seen as 'English'
- criticism of class system
- critical portrayal of foreign relations: eg aftermath of the First World War, appeasement, loyalty, treason.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- use of English butler as unreliable narrator with blinkered perspective
- use of English country house setting
- critical perspective presented through action, description, dialogue
- setting of England between the world wars
- retrospective chronological narrative that develops a critical viewpoint
- sustained irony in difference between narrator's point of view and reader's response
- language features: eg imagery, lexical choices, descriptive detail.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

Consider the narrative significance of the fact that Tower A is a block of apartments.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- closeness of relationships that follows from physical proximity
- how division of ownership leads to conflict
- links between Vishram Society (and what this implies) and architecture of Tower A
- narrative structure: eg gradual isolation of Masterji in his apartment
- sounds that travel through the building and the part these play in the narrative
- significance of roof terrace: eg suicide, Sandhya playing there, murder of Masterji.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Tower A as setting – key feature of narrative: eg for conflict, conspiracy, action
- plan of Vishram Society (Tower A) presented as preface
- placing of neighbours in building: eg Masterji above Pintos, beside Puris and opposite Ms Meenakshi
- 'apartments' might be unpicked for implications, so might 'block': eg households are separated, but are presented in relation to each other
- symbolism: eg Masterji attacked in his own apartment but taken to the roof terrace to be killed
- language features: eg lexical choices and imagery as features of description that reflect concerns and attitudes of residents.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	5
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Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

To what extent do you agree that the only problems Ifemelu experiences in America are those caused by racist attitudes?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- racist attitudes as they are discussed and challenged in Ifemelu's blogs
- race only becoming a problem after Ifemelu leaves Nigeria: eg 'I only became black when I came to America.'
- Ifemelu having to find work to support herself, exploitation by tennis coach and depression that follows
- losing contact with Obinza
- racist attitudes as pervasive rather than isolated
- irony that problem of racist attitudes provides Ifemelu with an opportunity and financial reward
- problems in personal relationships: eg being unfaithful to Curt and leaving him, row with Blaine.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative voice and 'outsider' perspective of Ifemelu
- chronological narrative that reveals developing understanding of and responses to racist attitudes
- blogs as form of commentary
- symbolism: eg 'hair the perfect metaphor for race in America', removing braids and straightening hair
- dialogue: eg comments by Laura showing her hostility towards Ifemelu, discussions at student meetings, conversations at parties
- use of different places: eg public arena of university, domestic settings
- language features: eg imagery, lexical choices, descriptive detail.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

'Jamaica is presented merely as a place to escape from.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Jamaica having limitations: eg Gilbert says, 'We Jamaicans are all small islanders.'
- Hortense leaving 'wretched parish school' in attempt to fulfil fantasy of English life
- Michael Roberts escaping from restraints of father, and joining RAF
- the desire to find work abroad: eg Gilbert's dialogue with Elwood concerning unemployment in Jamaica
- the returning First Jamaican Battalion: eg some men 'wept to feel home under their feet at last'
- migrants not rejecting lively Jamaican culture they carry with them
- Elwood being content to remain and wanting to resist British rule.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

With respect to significance of prose fiction methods:

- Gilbert's repeated references to Jamaica as a 'small island'
- use of different narrative voices with different perspectives on emigration
- dialogue: eg presentation of contrast in attitudes between Gilbert and Elwood
- narrative structure: eg Gilbert presented as immigrant before his wartime experiences and return to Jamaica to indicate determination to leave
- use of dialect to convey Jamaican culture
- description of Jamaican locations
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction method.

0	7
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Thomas Hardy poetry selection

To what extent do you agree that the main focus of Hardy's poetry is a troubled world?

Make detailed reference to 'In Time of The Breaking of Nations' and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- impending war in 'In Time of...', gunnery practice anticipates war in 'Channel Firing'
- loss in 'The Convergence of the Twain'
- bleakness that permeates 'The Darkling Thrush'
- threats and dangers in prospect for the unborn pauper child
- 'troubled form' of Earth in 'At A Lunar Eclipse'
- heartbreak on personal level: eg 'Neutral Tones' and 'The Going'
- other concerns and tribulation not being entirely unrelieved.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- unfolding structure of 'In Time of...' with movement from peaceful working scene in opening stanza to historical perspective in second, before return to opening setting but with threat of war in third
- voice and perspective
- structural features: eg contrast, rhetorical questions
- use of key images: eg thrush in bleak landscape, lunar eclipse
- sardonic humour of 'Channel Firing'
- lexical choices and figurative language
- rhymes to link images and ideas in 'In Time of...'.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	8
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William Wordsworth poetry selection

'Wordsworth teaches us nothing but respect for the natural world.'

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to 'Nutting' and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- explicit teaching of respect in 'Nutting', implicit teaching in other poems: eg 'Michael', 'Daffodils'
- respect for those close to nature: eg Michael, workers and sickly man in 'A Narrow Girdle...'
- how more than respect is taught: eg love for nature, metaphysical insights
- paradox of boy's exultation along with regret in 'Nutting'
- consideration of 'nothing but respect': eg strength of feeling shown and that more than respect can be found in the poems
- other things that may be 'taught': eg respect for humanity, spiritual presence in nature.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative voice and perspective with tone that can be understood as pedagogic
- structural features of narratives
- use of specific audience: eg in 'Nutting' and 'Tintern Abbey'
- contrast: eg anticipated pleasure in harvesting 'tempting cluster' and 'sense of pain' that follows despoliation
- use of first person to present direct experience
- reflection, introspection
- verse forms.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	9
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Robert Frost poetry selection

Consider the significance of open spaces in Frost's poetry. Make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- vastness of space and intensity of experience for tramp in 'An Unstamped Letter...'
- place for play in 'Birches'
- reassurance in 'On Looking Up...'
- possession by enclosure in 'Mending Wall'
- space for contemplation
- choice in 'The Road Not Taken'
- freedom implied by distant mountains in 'Out, Out –'

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- perspective: eg individual first-person voice
- structure: eg retrospective narrative in 'An Unstamped Letter...', description of scene leading to reflection, repetition
- verse forms – structural use of single stanza, as well as four-line and five-line stanzas
- tone in attitude towards addressee and subject matter
- use of speech rhythms
- structural use of rhyme
- figurative language, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

1 0 Seamus Heaney poetry Selection

'Heaney's focus on places tells us more about the distant past than about more contemporary matters.'

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to 'North' and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the recollection of Viking raiders and what drove their voyages
- how the recalled history influences the poet in his own time
- the influence of human sacrifice in the past on attitude towards twentieth century violence ('The Tollund Man')
- the narrative of 'The Bog Queen' with a focus on past events that have relevance for contemporary events
- the Irish rebellion of 1798 and defeat of Croppies with possible discussion of contemporary relevance
- personal history and political history – 'Act of Union'
- parallels between killing of bog people and punishment killings in Heaney's time – 'The Grauballe Man' and 'Punishment'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- narrative voices: eg first person and voice of history in 'North', a croppy speaking from his grave, the Bog Queen recounts her own history
- structure: change from distant past marked by change of voice in 'North', subject becomes defeat with 'Until on Vinegar Hill', changes in past time: eg decay precedes execution in 'Bog Queen'
- interweaving of description with personal response: eg 'The Tollund Man', 'Punishment'
- imagery of violence ('Tell-tale skin and teeth/Flecking the sleepers', 'cauled in tar'), but also of savage beauty: eg 'Punishment'
- mood as can be found in attitude of speaker towards subject: eg 'North', 'Punishment'
- tone as can be found in attitude of speaker towards reader: eg 'Bog Queen', 'Requiem for the Croppies'
- lexical choices for past events that resonate with contemporary significance.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.